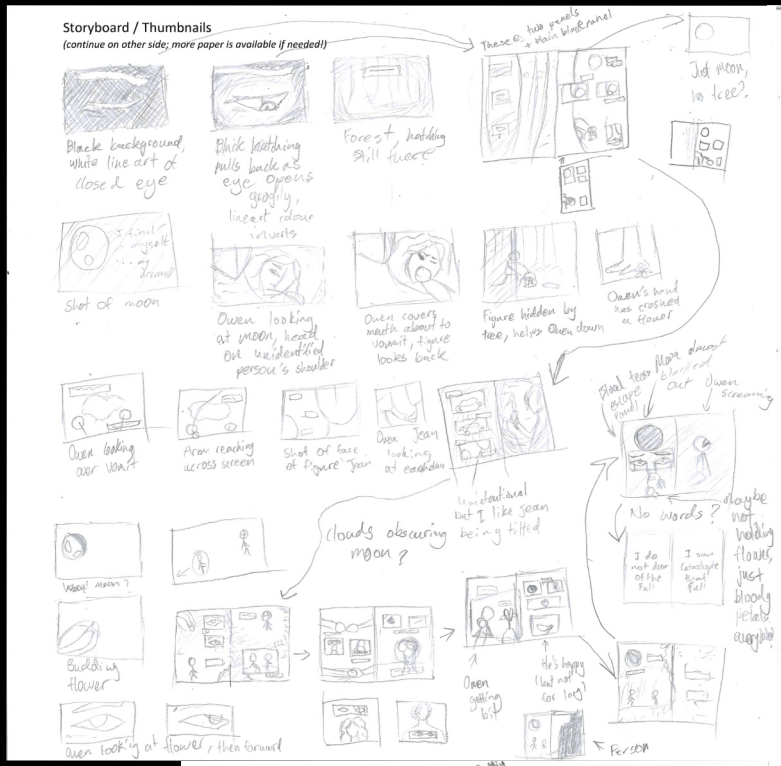
# Forever ends in the Fall

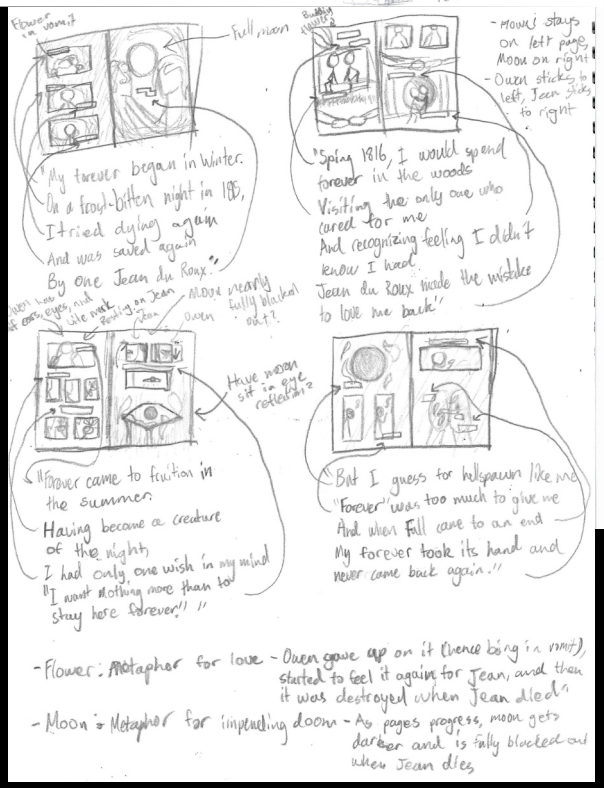
Project Workbook

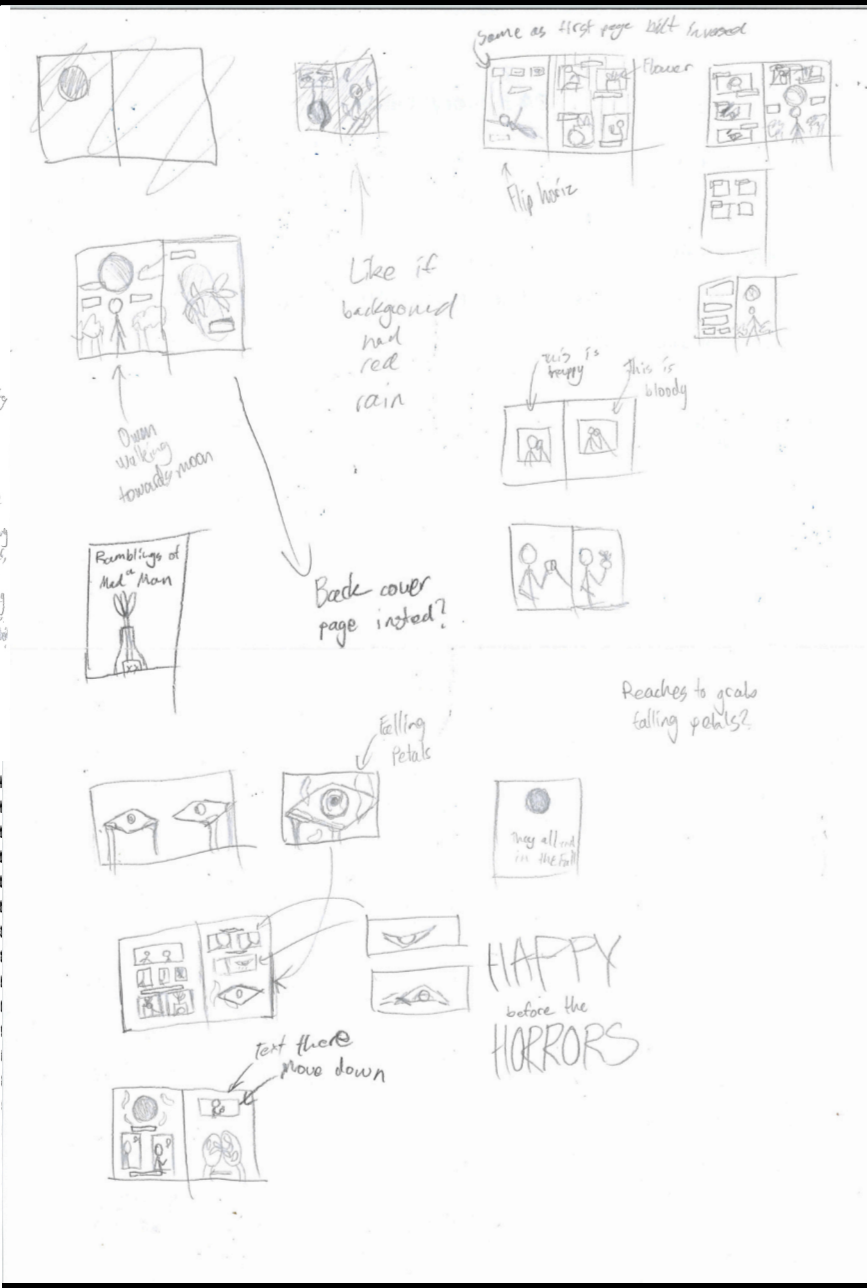
For my story, I chose to use the prompt 'Cinderella' as I wanted to draw a bit of backstory for my VTM character Owen whose dead lover is one of the most significant elements of his story. I was originally going to have the story be done to the poem 'Mad Girl's Love Song', but I wanted it to be something my own and came up with a piece called 'Ramblings of a mad man' (specifically seperately because he is both a mad man (angry), and a madman (lost his mind after his lover died)). When I was doing the storyboards, that was what I was working with, **but I ran into issues because of just how many pages would be required to get it all out**. Because of that, I changed the piece to a poem I thought up called 'Forever ends in the Fall', which was a far shorter version of 'Ramblings of a mad man'

Furthermore, when I was storyboarding, I was also thinking up **visual motifs** I could use because the death of Owen's lover is still a bit ambivelant and if my friends were to see it I didn't want them to get spoiled as to what the full story was. **I also noticed I was using the moon a lot**, and felt like the moon could be a nice way to both indicate that the events happen at night because yknow vampires, but also to act as a **bit of an indication to the viewers that something bad is going to happen as the moon gets progessively darker and darker as the pages go by until the event of Jean's death (Owen's lover)**. I also leaned into the motif of a flower that could go alongside **the portrayal of the seasons** and also act as a **visual indicator of the love blooming (get it) between the two**. It also meant that when Jean dies **I could use the flower to show to the viewer what happened without needing to show how Jean died or Jean's dead body.**

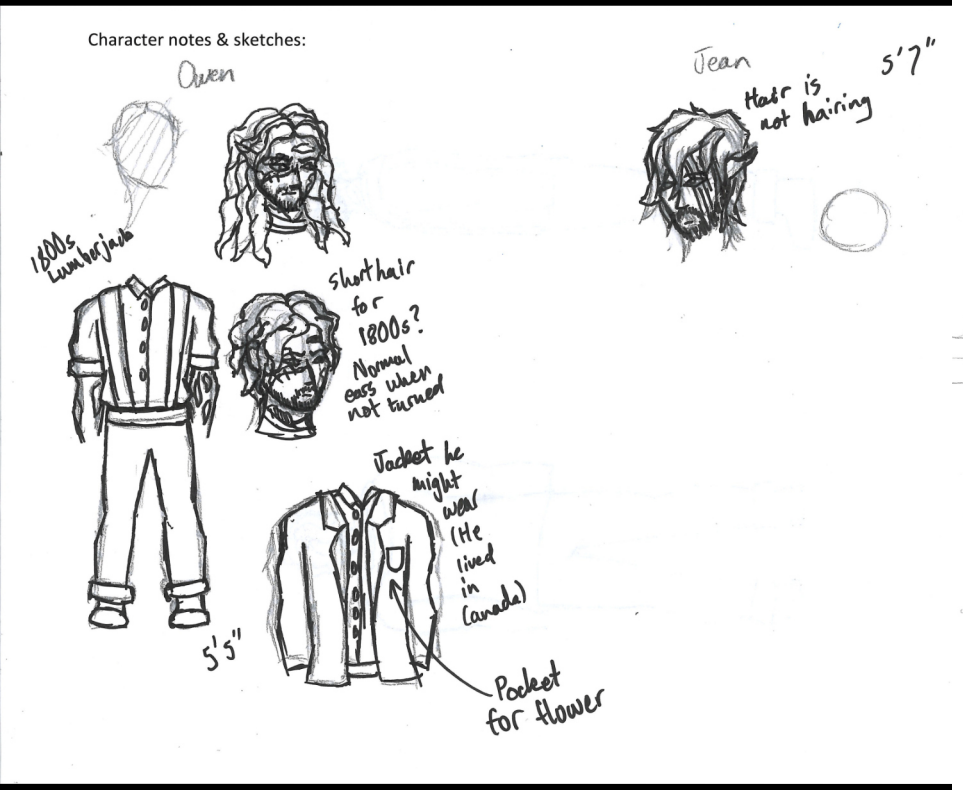
A thing I also tried to do to sort of show that things went wrong was **the placement of the two motifs in the layouts**. In every double page spread before the last bit of the third one and the final one, **the flower exclusively appears on the left and the moon exclusively appears on the right,** which also coincidentally allows for **the fates of the characters to line up with the motifs as Owen is almost always on the left and Jean is almost always on the right**, meaning that the flower is something more inherently tied to Owen while the moon is more intrinsically tied to Jean.

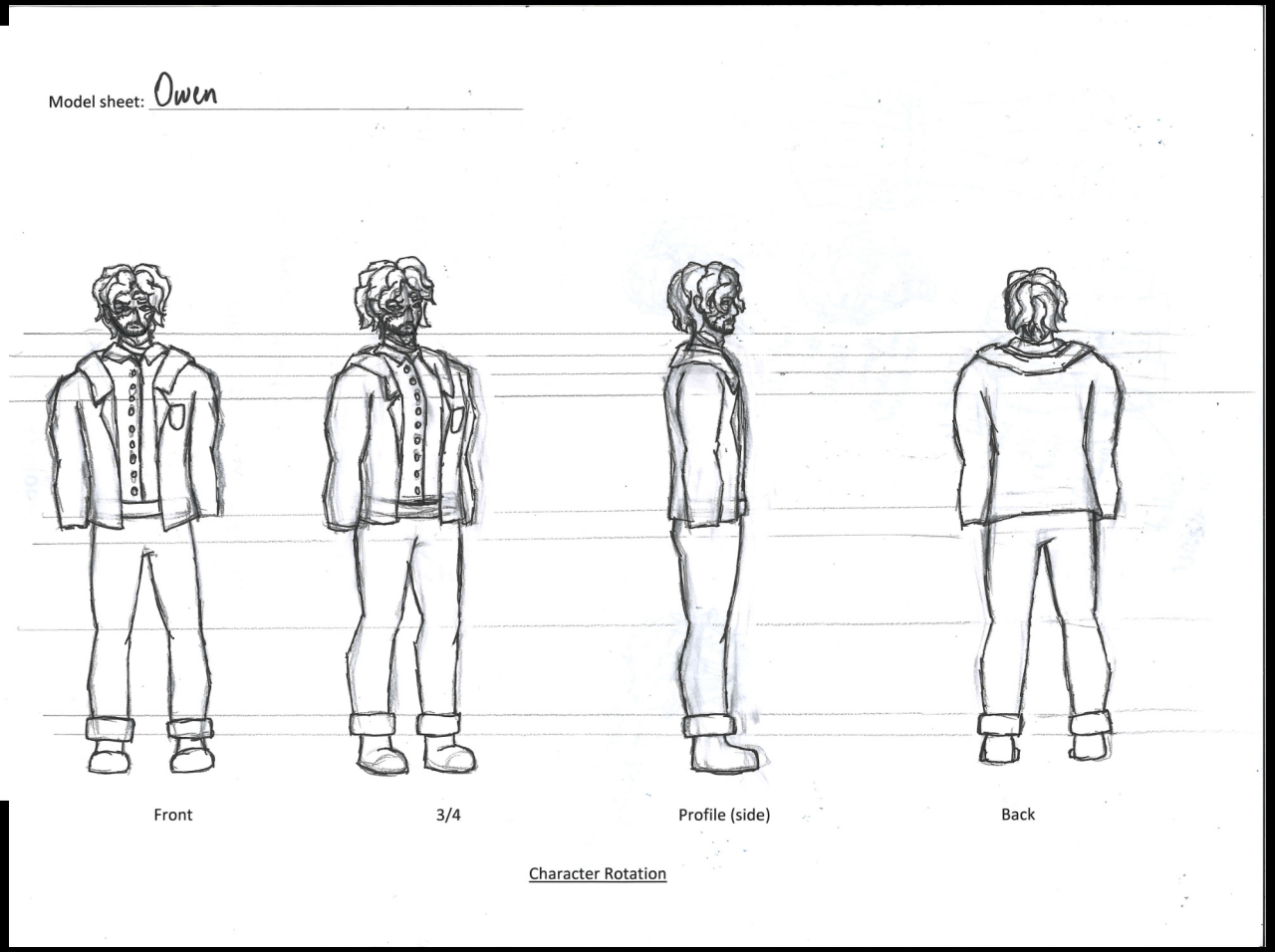


For character modelling, I used a drawing I made of Owen and Jean as reference. However, there were some mild things I needed to change. First of all, Owen isn't a vampire when he meets Jean, so he shouldn't have pointy ears for most of the story. Second, he was a lumberjack in the early 1800s, so he probably wouldn't have had long hair. For body and clothing, he was living in Canada when these events took place. It can get cold up there, so I knew I had to give him a jacket so he doesn't freeze to death. I also took a look at some of the clothing worn by lumberjacks and used them as reference**. I also added a pocket to Owen's jacket so that the flower could be placed there to show him finally getting some love in his life after he gave up on it (the bit where he vomits and the flower is in the vomit is meant to show him giving up on it).**



For drawing, I decided to use one of the **Wacom tablets** at Te Auaha. I used **Photoshop** to draw the pages. In terms of style **I did debate between having everything be fully coloured or having it all in black and white, and I eventually settled on it being mostly black and white with the flower being the only thing in colour (pink, a colour usually associated with love) so it stands out more and the reader pays more attention to it** and therefore is able to understand the Jean died without it needing to be outright stated that he died (the wording I chose for the final scene was a bit ambigious, but I really wanted to keep it, so the only way to make it clear he's dead is visually communicate it). Most of the testing I did was testing out contrast and shading and also hatching. While I did use hatching to indicate darker shadows and textures, **one of the main ways I wanted to use it was to act as a textured gradient of sorts for backgrounds and foregrounds as I felt they were a nice way to indicate focal points for the reader. I let it be a lot less prevelant on one of the summer pages so that when it entered the final act it could be very dramatic.** Another thing I did was place dark greys under the hatching in order to better achieve the contrast and focal points I wanted. A small note I also wanted to make was that I decided to have it be that the black and white is indicative of the lighting and not of the colour value. Furthermore, I decided (closer to the end of finishing everything, hence why it's a bit shaded in the Fall pages) that the most shading the flower would get would be some hatching and that it wouldn't have proper shading on the pink so it'd really stand out against everything else.

